



Position Description

Title	Family Violence Justice Project Worker
Employment type	0.4 FTE (4 days per fortnight) for 12 months
Hours of work	Between business hours 9am-5pm, Monday to Friday 210 Lonsdale St, Melbourne
Salary	SCHADS Award Level 5 (plus superannuation)
Conditions	• Access to salary packaging • Additional week of annual leave • Offer of employment subject to review following a three-month period of induction
Reports to	FVJP Coordinator

About Flat Out Inc

Flat Out is a dynamic and innovative advocacy and support service for women, trans and gender-diverse people who have been criminalised through Victoria's criminal legal and/or prison system. Flat Out has a commitment to providing high-quality, innovative and effective services and advocacy with all people accessing our services.

Flat Out leads and participates in research and community education, seeking to inform the broader community and other service providers about the issues for women, trans and gender-diverse people in the criminal legal system. Through community involvement and education, advocacy and research, Flat Out maintains a strong voice in the prison abolition movement in Australia.

The Flat Out team is based at **Level 2, 210 Lonsdale Street, Melbourne.**

Flat Out recognises the extreme injustices experienced by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples and acknowledges the unacceptable and disproportionate over-representation of First Nations people in the criminal legal system. Flat Out strongly encourages Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people to apply.

Flat Out embraces diversity and welcomes staff and service users of all backgrounds, including cis women and people from the Trans, non-binary and gender-diverse community. We also encourage people with a lived experience of the criminal legal system to apply.

All service users and staff are invited to contribute to agency policy decisions, agency directions, social justice/advocacy initiatives and projects in any way they choose.

About the project – Family Violence and Criminalisation of Women

Family Safety Victoria has funded Flat Out Inc. to undertake a dedicated project to improve the accessibility and responsiveness of the service system to women who are criminalised and experiencing family violence or at risk of experiencing family violence. The Royal Commission into Family Violence identified that support for women exiting prison, including women who have been previously incarcerated is inadequate.

Women who have been criminalised require a specialised approach for service delivery based on their particular social and individual circumstances. Most criminalised women experience multiple forms of discrimination stemming not only from their criminalisation but also from their over-representation as Aboriginal or CALD women, as women with mental health and/or drug and alcohol issues, and women with disabilities.

The project aims to:

- Enhance understanding of the complexity of criminalised women's experiences of family violence and barriers to accessing services.
- Assist services to enhance responses to criminalised women to ensure accessible, inclusive and non-discriminatory service delivery.

Position Overview

The Family Violence Justice Project Worker will play a key role in building competency and awareness of the needs of women, trans and gender-diverse people who are criminalised and experiencing family violence. They will contribute to systemic advocacy and sector change, through capacity building work designed to resource the family violence and generalist service systems to recognise and resist systemic harms, build decarceral practice capacity and improve safety and wellbeing for these people and communities.

The Family Violence Justice Project Worker will work in partnership with the Family Violence Justice Project Coordinator and the Formerly Incarcerated Justice Advocate Collective (FIGJAM). The project team works alongside the Outreach, Support and Advocacy Team to improve service outcomes, drive systemic change, and provide support to ensure assessments, policies and processes are responsive and appropriate to victim-survivors of family violence.

All employees must be familiar with and operate within the Flat Out organisation framework, including supporting our vision, values and plans.

Key Responsibilities

Professional Education and Community Development

- Provide secondary consultations to individual services to improve responses to clients who are criminalised and experiencing family violence.
- Develop and deliver or coordinate flexible training packages on women, trans and gender diverse people who are criminalised and experiencing family violence.
- Develop web content and other promotional and educative materials to support more effective responses for women who are criminalised and experiencing family violence. Liaise with key family violence resource providers.
- Develop and deliver or coordinate cross-sector practice forums on women who are criminalised and experiencing family violence.

- Resource Flat Out support workers through provision of information, advice and support to enhance responses and referral pathways for clients experiencing family violence.

Relationships and Partnerships

- Develop and build relationships with community agencies and family violence specialist services to create sustainable partnerships and referral pathways.
- Actively network to build awareness of the complexities surrounding access to services and provision of specialist support for women, trans and gender diverse people who are criminalised.
- Identify opportunities for information sharing, collaboration and participation in sector wide advocacy, training and service development.

Policy and Advocacy

- Identify the barriers to accessing family violence services that women, trans and gender diverse people who are criminalised experience, including the structural, systemic and social barriers and how they compound and intersect. Develop and action recommendations to improve access and participation.
- Develop or coordinate development of resources to inform policies and best practice and actively contribute to projects and program development including ongoing review of the Domestic Violence Victoria Code of Practice.

Data Collection and Evaluation

- Lead project evaluation and reporting including collection of data such as client case studies and stakeholder feedback.
- Collaboratively (with the FVJP Coordinator and the FIGJAM collective) develop recommendations for the ongoing project.

Organisational Accountabilities

- Comply with Flat Out policies and procedures, practice manuals, service agreements and other relevant agency or legislative obligations.
- Contribute to continuous quality improvement activities across the organisation.
- Contribute to a positive organisational culture and positively promote the organisation externally.
- Work in a manner that does not adversely affect own health and safety or that of others.
- Actively participate and present in team meetings, supervision, networks and other meetings as required.
- Contribute to general office maintenance.
- Undertake other role related duties as requested by the Coordinator and/or Executive Officer.

All Flat Out employees are encouraged and, at times, expected to:

- Participate in research and data collection activities when required.
- Participate in developing and implementing programs, activities, and pilot projects as required.
- Participate in evaluating and planning projects that determine the direction for Flat Out's work as required.
- Participate in developing and building community/sector networks and partnerships that align with Flat Out's purpose, vision and mission and contribute to creating the best possible outcomes for the people we support.

Attend training, workshops or conferences that enhance their knowledge, skills, and capacity to contribute to Flat Out's work and uphold its values.

Key Selection Criteria

1. Knowledge and understanding of the drivers of women, trans and gender-diverse people's incarceration and post-release issues.
2. Demonstrated commitment to social justice and intersectional feminist principles, informed by sound knowledge of the ways in which racism, colonisation and white supremacy drive criminalisation and incarceration.
3. Demonstrated experience developing and delivering training or workshops.
4. Demonstrated experience working in complex service systems particularly (but not limited to) family violence, homelessness, drug and alcohol, and mental health, and ability to identify barriers, opportunities and solutions.
5. Ability to build relationships and networks and work collaboratively to drive change.
6. Excellent communication skills including ability to write reports and create document guides.
7. Strong organisational and project management skills including data collection and evaluation, and ability to prioritise tasks and meet deadlines.
8. Ability to work autonomously and as part of a team, with demonstrated experience working in an accountable, collaborative, professional and respectful manner.
9. Competency in using Windows software and Excel applications and capacity to maintain appropriate records and files.

Desirable Specialist Expertise

- Experience supporting and advocating for women, trans and gender diverse people who have been impacted by systemic harms including criminalisation is highly regarded.
- Experience working in the family violence service system is highly regarded.
- Lived Expertise including experience of Family Violence and/or the criminal-legal system is highly regarded.
- Tertiary qualification in Social Services (e.g. BA or Masters in Social Work, Psychology, Human Services) or equivalent experience highly regarded

Essential Requirements

- A current police check (and international police check if necessary) and a current Working with Children Check. These checks are required for accreditation but do not necessarily impact appointment.
- A current Victorian Driver's Licence.
- Current First Aid (or preparedness to undertake)

General Statement

Please note this position description is a general outline of the duties, responsibilities and requirements for eligibility for the role. It is not an exhaustive or mandatory statement. We understand that many barriers to education and employment exist for many in our communities, that life skills and skills from other sectors and contexts are often transferrable, and that important qualities such as values, politics and disposition are not dictated by employment history. If you feel drawn to this role but have concerns or questions about barriers to access please feel encouraged to apply.

Please also note that Flat Out is a small organisation necessarily working from a flexible, collaborative approach. Therefore it is possible that review of the position description and amendments may sometimes be required to meet organisational needs, and employees may be asked to perform other duties within their scope of skill and comfort.

I have read, understood and accept the above position description:

Employee Name: _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: ____/____/____

How to apply

Women, trans, and gender-diverse people—especially those with lived experience of criminalisation, First Nations people, and those from racially marginalised communities—are strongly encouraged to apply.

Applications should include the following documents:

- a cover letter
- a response to the key selection criteria
- a current CV with three recent referees including most recent manager or supervisor

Applicants who do not address the key selection criteria will not be considered.

Applications close Sunday, 23rd of March 2025.